

Student Leadership Training SGA Finances and Funding August 2025

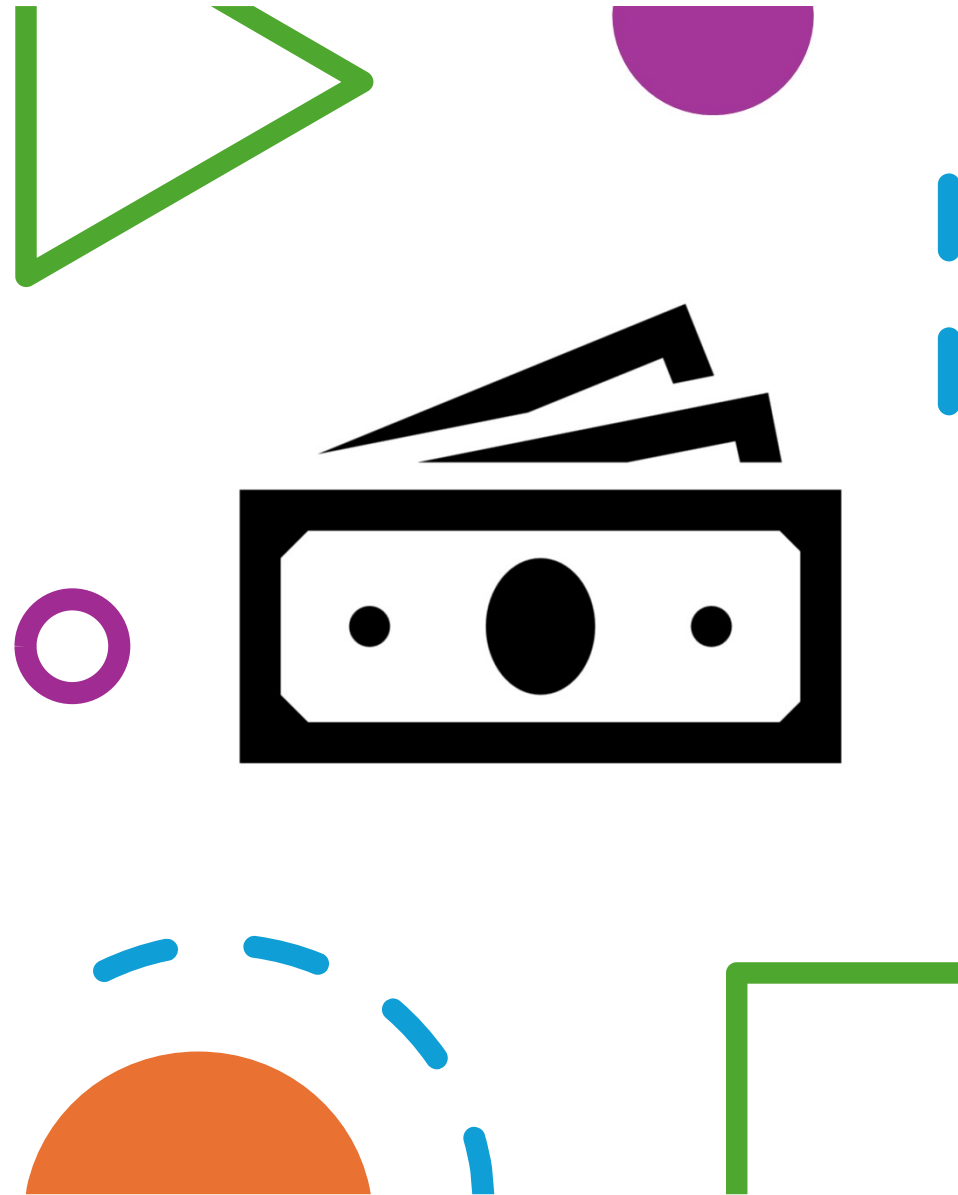


FURMAN
UNIVERSITY

STUDENT INVOLVEMENT

Today's Agenda

- Fundraising and Payment Collection
- Expenditure Guidelines and Best Practices
- Accessing your SGA Budget/New Money Request



Fundraising for Student Organizations

- As student leaders, you should have a full awareness of the university's expectations about student fundraising activities before your organization plans an event.
- Please be thoughtful when planning to engage in fundraising- do so only when you have specific goals or expenses that exceed their current revenue projections.
- Fundraising goals should be clear, concise and communicated to customers in writing-usually with signage at the event.



All events should be registered in syncDIN at least 5 business days prior. OSI has the authority to deny any fundraising event registration.

Please do not use anyone's personal accounts to accept payments (NO VENMO, PAYPAL, BANK ACCOUNTS etc).

Student organizations can host events for a philanthropic cause. 100% of all income generated from a philanthropic event must be given to the charitable organization.

Student Organizations are prohibited from co-sponsoring philanthropic events and/or fundraisers in conjunction with any alcohol distributor, bar, or tavern or hosting philanthropic events at such locations.

Student groups are not allowed to hold traditional raffles, a game of chance in which purchasers **exchange money** for tickets that are then **entered into a drawing** for a prize due to state tax laws.



How do student groups collect money/payments?

- **CASH**-You can collect cash at your event and bring to me at the Office of Student Involvement.
- **CREDIT CARD PAYMENTS**-Most of the time, you can use our credit card reader, but we also have Nel Net and Event Brite, which we will go over in the next slide.
- The Office of Student Involvement will make sure your funds are deposited into your cost center. If you use the SGA cost center (which most of you do), OSI will keep track of your funds for you-they will not be combined with other organizations.



Use Nelnet to accept payments for:

- Registration Fees
- Club Dues
- “Day of” sales at the door of an alcohol-free event



Use the OSI Credit Card Reader to accept payments for:

- In-person sales/tabling (bake sales, car washes, etc.)
- Uniform or T-Shirt Orders
- BRAND NEW MACHINE-NO MORE BATCHING!



Use Furman’s Eventbrite platform to accept payments for:

- Pre-sales of ticketed events such as plays, concerts, etc.
- Please note student groups should only use Furman



HOW DO I REQUEST THE CREDIT CARD MACHINE/NELNET/EVENTBRITE?

Any student organization wanting to collect non-cash payments will need to fill out the syncDIN form shown below. It is on the **Office of Student Involvement syncDIN Page**.

2025-2026 Student Organization Fundraising and Revenue Request

Start Date: Tue, Aug 12, 2025 1:06 PM EDT, End Date: Fri, Apr 24, 2026 1:06 PM EDT

Total Submissions: 0 Pending: 0 Approved: 0 Denied: 0 Received: 0

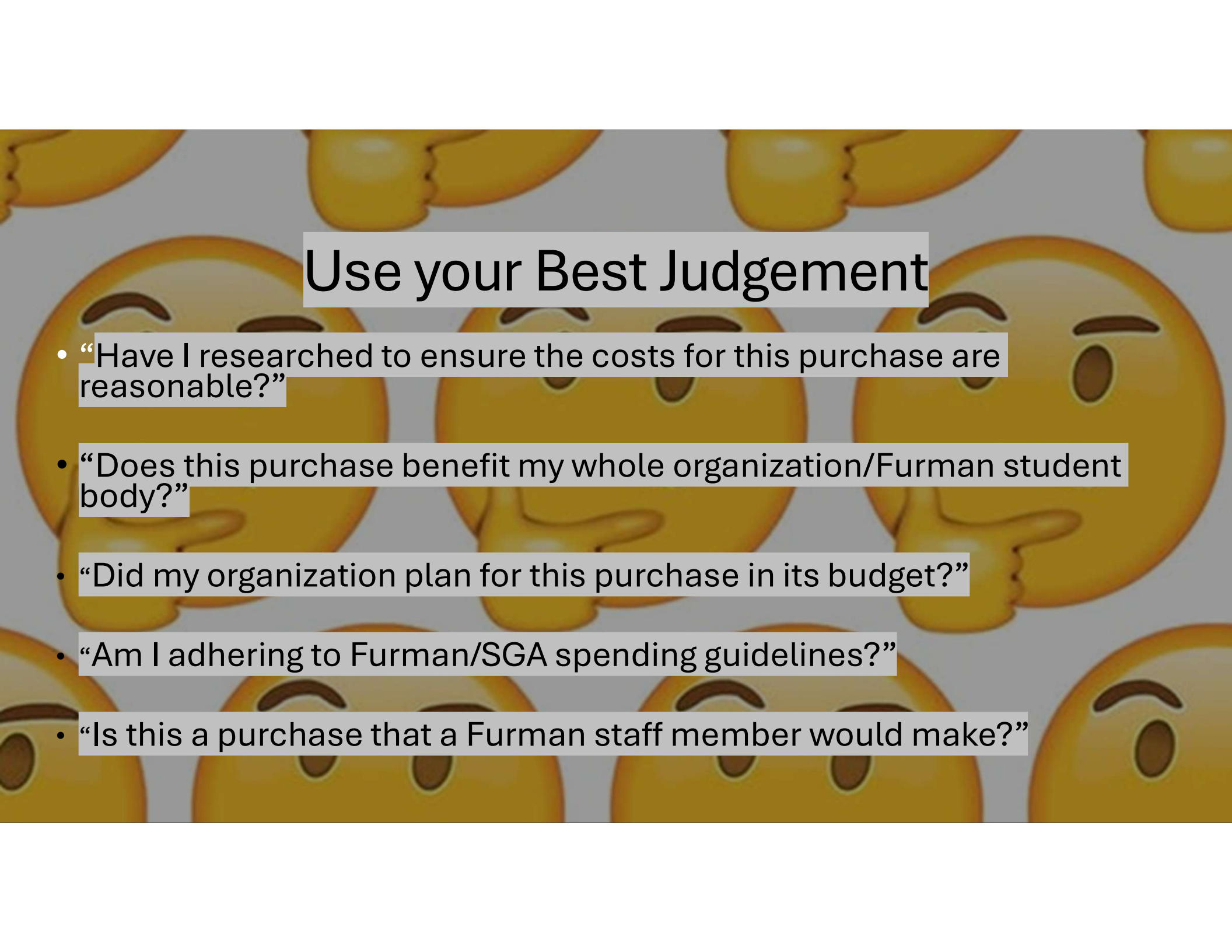


Expenditure Guidelines and Best Practices

Remember JAR

- JUDGEMENT (use your best)
- ACCOUNTABILITY (to Furman students present and future)
- RESPONSIBILITY (good stewardship)





Use your Best Judgement

- “Have I researched to ensure the costs for this purchase are reasonable?”
- “Does this purchase benefit my whole organization/Furman student body?”
- “Did my organization plan for this purchase in its budget?”
- “Am I adhering to Furman/SGA spending guidelines?”
- “Is this a purchase that a Furman staff member would make?”

Show Accountability in your decisions

- Think of SGA as a business, with you and your fellow student leaders being business partners.
- While you want to provide for your individual club, you are also accountable to SGA and Furman University as a whole.
- As a student leader you set an example for all your club members and want to be sure they are being responsible as well.
- When making purchases, think of other SGA business partners. Is this a purchase they would approve? Would you approve it for their organization?





Be a Responsible Leader



- Student ownership of SGA funds comes with the responsibility to be good stewards of the funds.
- SGA has to be sustainable in the future and the decisions you make are an important part of that happening.
- To be a good steward of SGA funds, you need to be aware of spending best practices, keep track of your club's budget and follow the rules in place to use your budget.



Important Expense Guidelines

- Tips should not exceed 20% of purchase subtotal for onsite deliveries/caterers or 10% of purchase subtotal for pick-up orders.
- Keep prizes at less than \$100.
- Do not “round up” to make donations at stores or online. SGA funds cannot be used to make donations, directly or indirectly.
- Items like apparel, stickers, cups, buttons, stress balls, etc. are meant to be purchased for the purpose of promoting your organization. **Please do not buy these items to recognize or reward individual organization members.**
- **See full list on the SGA syncDIN page- document is called SGA EXPENSE GUIDELINES**

- Items purchased using an organization's SGA budget should not fall under the personal ownership of the organization's members with the following exceptions:

- Prizes/Giveaways from an approved event if it is open to all students.
- Furman or organization branded apparel and promotional items.
- Graduation cords, pins or medals, maximum \$25.00 per graduate.
- Items that are \$25.00 or less in value and that have been approved for personal ownership by the SGA Executive Treasurer and/or Finance Committee; this includes senior gifts.
- SGA funds may not be used to buy student, staff or advisor appreciation gifts.
- SGA funds can be used to purchase an appreciation gift for a non-advisor staff, faculty or professional guest that volunteers their time at a specific event, maximum of \$50 per person.

Student Food and Travel

- SGA funds may be used to purchase food items for events and club meetings that are open to all students. The maximum SGA will cover is \$20.00 per student that is expected to attend.
- It is best practice that food for individual club meetings be limited to small items like snacks, desserts, etc. **Clubs should not be in the habit of offering meals at every club meeting.**
- SGA funds may not be used to purchase food, gifts or fund travel expenses etc. for alumni, non-Furman students or organization advisors.
- SGA will not cover expenses for end of year events/team bonding that take place off-campus. This rule does not apply to organization retreats that serve a business purpose and off campus events hosted for the entire student body.

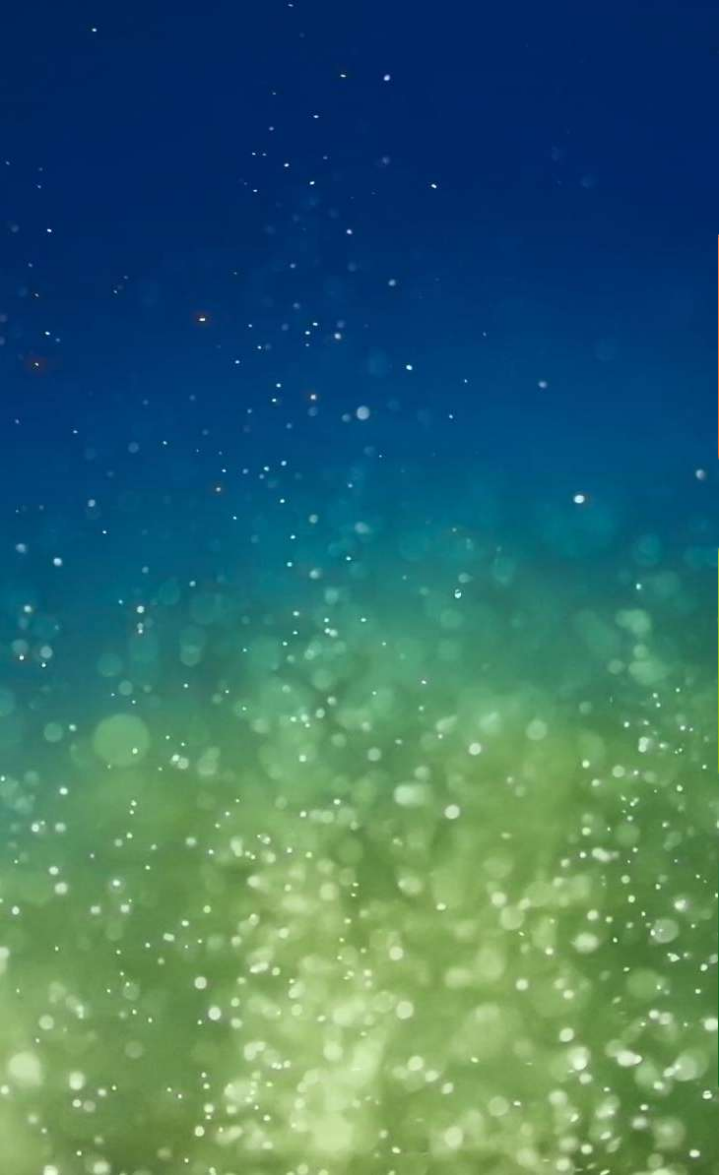


- Student travel and lodging costs, and conference registration fees may be covered by SGA monies **only for attendance at educational events/conferences, tournaments or other activities that are open to the entire student body. Student entertainment while traveling will not be covered by SGA funds.**
- SGA funds may be used to pay for planned food purchases while on such a trip up to \$50.00 per day. Meals will be allotted as follows: \$10 breakfast, \$15 lunch, \$25 dinner. If the hotel includes any meals, these will be deducted from reimbursement.
- If students pay for air travel, registration fees, etc. out of pocket, reimbursement will happen AFTER event takes place and student returns to campus. Students are able to use the SGA credit card instead to book approved travel and register for approved events. Please plan ahead.
- Individual clubs should be incorporating all travel costs into their budgets. Many organizations will ask members to cover some expenses while traveling.

Hotels and Airbnb

Student groups using SGA funds for overnight travel are expected to follow these guidelines:

- Hotel/Airbnb must be booked in the name of the student group/student officer, not Furman University
- Airbnb are approved only on a case-by-case basis. The legal department has several requirements that must be met. Please contact Leslie Hoffmann in the Office of Student Involvement to set up a meeting BEFORE you request to rent an Airbnb.
- Students should be sharing rooms to reduce expenses.
- Furman University expects students to book lodging to ensure single sex rooms/Airbnb.
- UNDER NO CIRCUMSTANCES are non-Furman students, minors or alumni allowed to stay in the room/Airbnb.



Budget Reminders

If your organization submitted a budget last Spring, you should have received your preliminary budget. If you do not have that information, please contact Caroline Orr at.

Final budgets will be determined next month after student activity fees are finalized. Caroline will make a recommendation on final budgets and SGA Council votes to approve. You have had access to your budget as of August 1st, but since it is not a final number, please keep requests to essential items only.

Be mindful that your budget is for the whole year. Please do not rely on New Money Requests as they are not guaranteed.

We don't have a 25-26 budget!

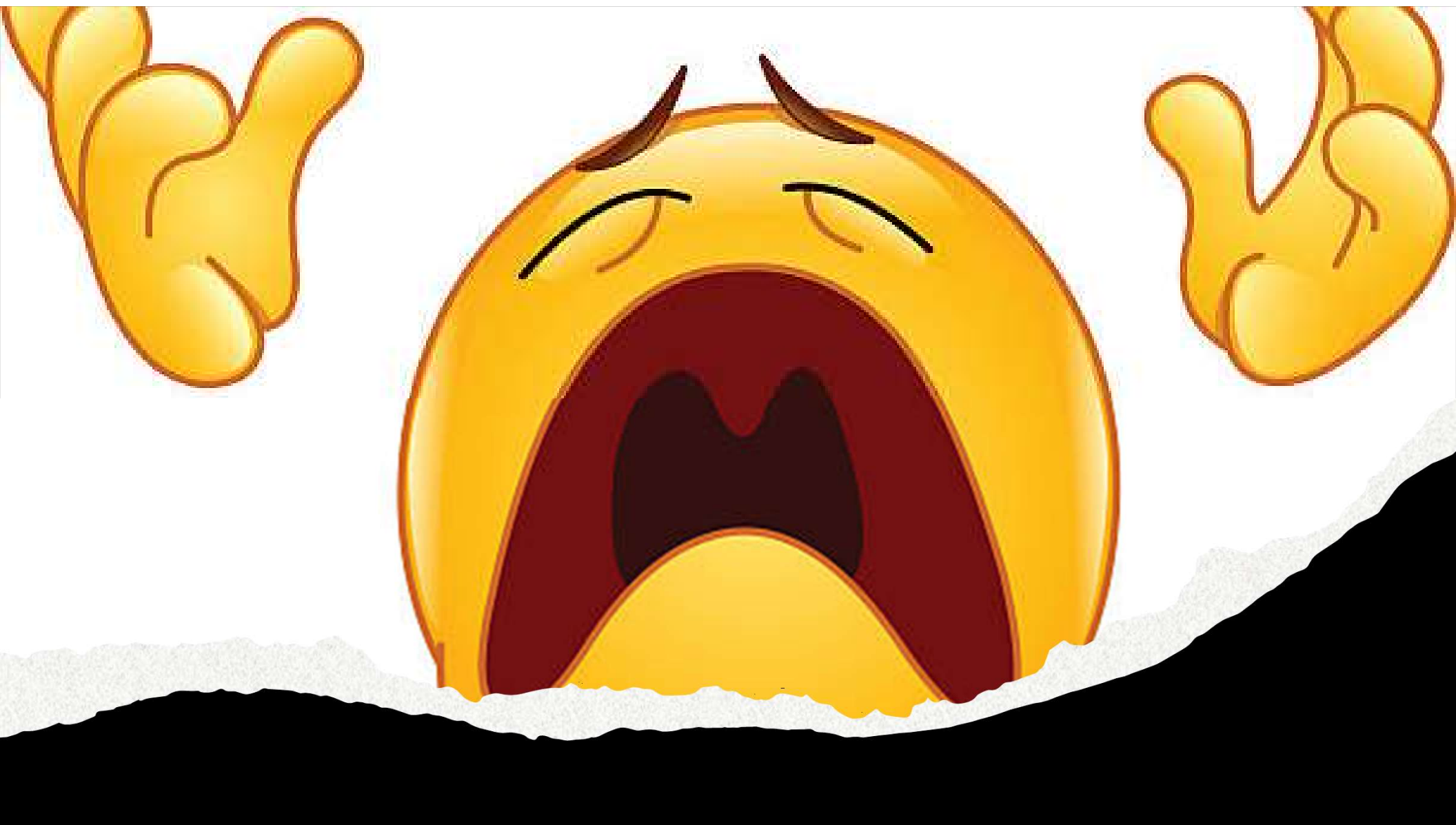
- Organizations that do not have a budget can request funds via the New Money Request Form.
- If funds are available, your request will be considered. New Money Requests are not guaranteed.
- This form is reviewed by Caroline Orr and the Finance Committee at their weekly meetings
- However, anything \$1,000 or more must be approved by an SGA council vote.
- If you are the 25-26 Treasurer, please be sure to submit a budget this upcoming Spring for your organization's 26-27 activities, so that next year's student leaders have initial access to funds.





How do you access your funds/How do you spend money?

- In order to use your budget/new money, you will need to fill out the appropriate form on the SGA syncDIN page.
- These forms are reviewed by Caroline Orr and the Finance committee weekly. You will receive a notice once your purchase is approved.
- If the purchase is denied, you will also receive an explanation as to why.
- The forms are organized by type of payment you are requesting.
- Please be sure to provide details on your request and to answer all questions.



This is WHY....

- All purchases need to be either reconciled or requested in Workday- we need a system to keep track of expenditures.
- Individual purchases still need to be reviewed by the Finance Committee, to ensure they adhere to Furman policy and guidelines
- Finance Committee also confirms that the organization has enough funds to cover the purchase.



Forms you will
need to
complete to
spend your
budget/new
money request!

(all found on SGA SyncDIN
page-or type name of form in
search bar)

2025-2026 SGA OR DEPARTMENTAL CREDIT
CARD USE REQUEST

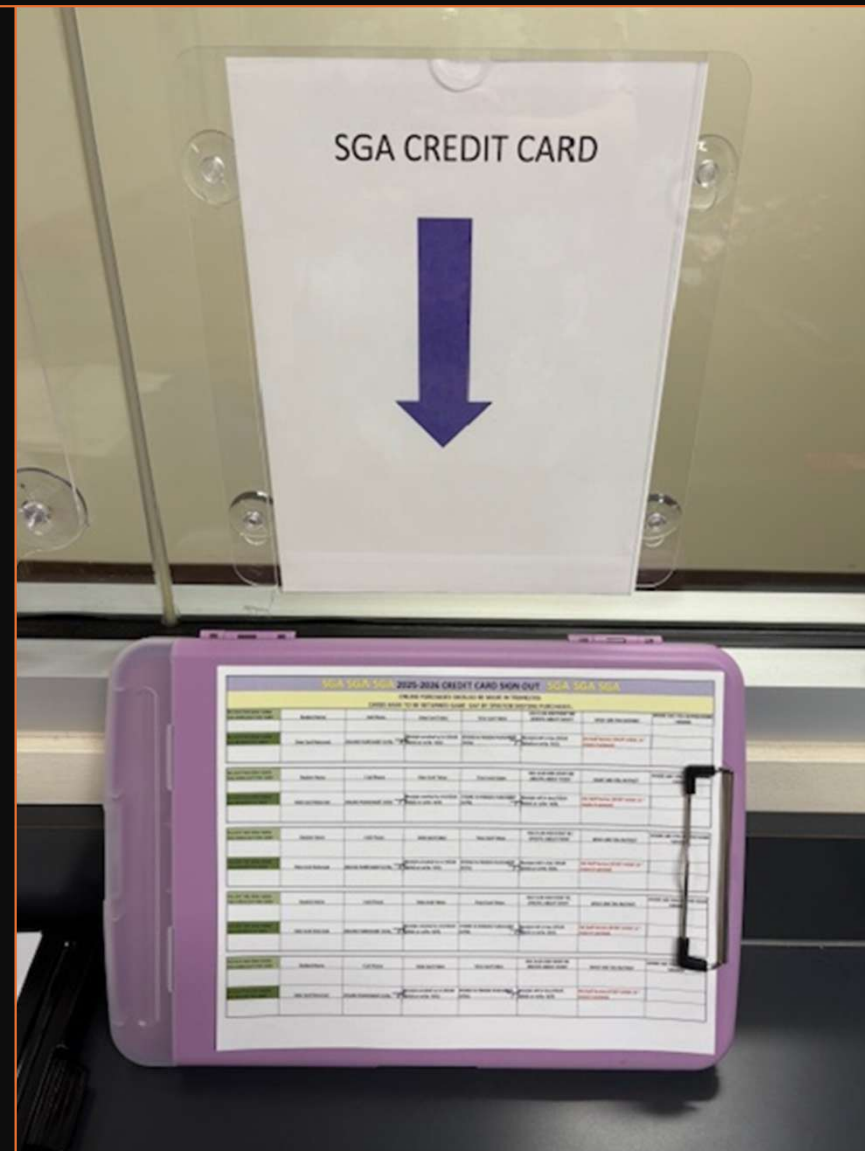
2025-2026 SGA AMAZON/STAPLES PURCHASE
REQUEST

2025-2026 SGA STUDENT REIMBURSEMENT
REQUEST

2025-2026 CHECK REQUEST

2024-2025 STUDENT PAYMENT REQUEST
(WORKDAY EMPLOYEE)

The SGA credit card is
in the Office of
Student Involvement,
Trone Center Suite
206



HOW MANY
STUDENT GROUP
CREDIT CARD
TRANSACTIONS
DID OSI
RECONCILE
LAST ACADEMIC
YEAR?!



Important Details about the SGA Credit Card

- Once your purchase is approved, you can sign the card out. You DO NOT need an appointment to sign the card out.
- YOU MUST PROVIDE RECEIPT FOR EVERY PURCHASE YOU MAKE.
- Physical receipts should be left when you return the card. Online receipts should be emailed to the OSI Business Manager (leslie.hoffmann@furman.edu) AS SOON AS YOUR PURCHASE IS COMPLETE.
- If you are making an online purchase and emailing the receipt, please mention your organization in the subject line of the email.
- Online purchases will need to be made in the Trone Center; do not sign out the card until you are ready to make the purchase.
- If you are making an in-person purchase, please pick the card up as close as possible to the time you will be making the purchase; there are many organizations that use the card.
- Please write your organization's name and the event on physical receipts.

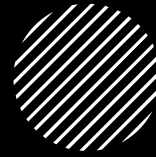
Your responsibility when using an SGA credit card

Remember JAR-treat the card as you would your personal credit card or the card of a company you worked for or owned. We have to account for and reconcile every transaction

Improper use of the credit card will be considered misappropriation of university funds, which may result in disciplinary action including the entire organization losing access to spending. Improper use includes, but is not limited to:

- using the card for guideline-violating expenses
- using the card without an approved SyncDIN form
- using the card for additional purchases that were not approved
- returning the card without receipts
- keeping the card for over 24 hours
- adding the card information to personal accounts
- taking photos of the card
- using the card at Amazon or Staples





- NEW in 25-26-ALL Amazon and Staples purchases must be completed in Workday.
- In the past, we would allow these purchases on credit card at times, but we cannot do that starting the year.
- This is a requirement from the Finance department, and it pertains to the all employees as well, not just student organizations.
- Please do not use your own credit card to make Amazon or Staples purchases for your organization as these purchases WILL NOT be reimbursed.
- Fill out the SyncDIN form for Amazon/Staples purchases. Once your purchase is approved, you need to send me a list of the items you need via email-PLEASE do not forget this step!

SyncDIN Forms FAQs



Do I need to revise my form if I asked to buy something at Walmart but went to Publix instead?

Answer: NO



Do I need to fill out a new form if I asked for an Amazon purchase but had to shop in person instead?

Answer:NO-I (Leslie) would let you know Amazon is not available and then you could sign out the SGA credit card to make your purchase



I forgot to account for sales tax! Do I have to provide the updated amount?

Answer: NO



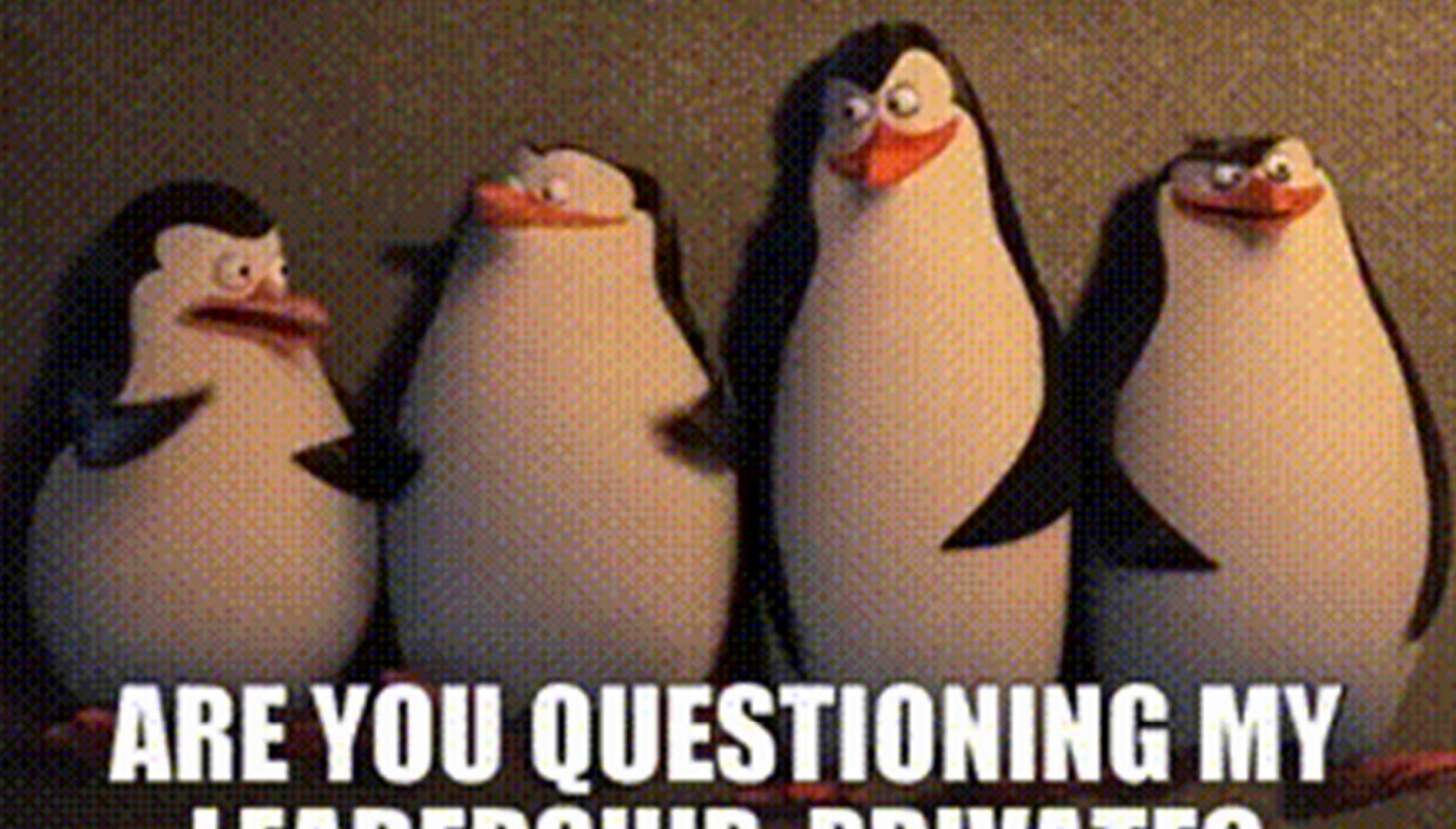
My club needs a few more things! Can I buy items not included in my original request?

Answer: NO-please submit a new request.



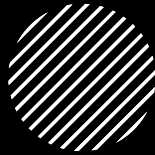
I asked to buy 3 bags of chips, but we need 5 bags....you aren't really going to make me fill out another form, are you?

Answer:NO, but please use your judgement in this scenario. There is a difference between buying extra snacks and buying an extra airplane ticket.

A meme featuring four penguins from the animated film Madagascar. The penguins are standing in a row against a dark, textured background. From left to right: the first penguin is looking slightly to the right with a neutral expression; the second penguin is looking up and to the right with a slightly open beak; the third penguin is looking directly at the camera with a wide-eyed, questioning expression; the fourth penguin is looking slightly to the left with a neutral expression. The text "ARE YOU QUESTIONING MY LEADERSHIP, PRIVATE?" is overlaid in white, bold, sans-serif capital letters at the bottom of the image.

**ARE YOU QUESTIONING MY
LEADERSHIP, PRIVATE?**

Please
contact us-we
are here to
support you!



Important

Caroline Orr, SGA Executive
Treasurer

orrca9@furman.edu

Leslie Hoffmann, OSI Business
Manager

leslie.hoffmann@furman.edu

864-294-2241

Trone Center Suite 206

Caroline and Leslie meet on Tuesdays at 1:30pm! Email one of us to join or both of us to schedule a meeting at a different time.